

Unit One- The Scramble for Africa

Part Three- East Africa

- Britain was very involved because Cape Route was a long route to India (strategic value).
- East Africa was a strategic point for controlling the Indian Ocean
- No trade links!
- Robinson and Gallagher would say that E.A. proves that Britain preferred to make an empire in poor E.A. than to make it wealthier in rich W.A, as they were more interested in strategic value.

Whether or not was it all about strategic value??

*There had been since **1830** lots of informal influence over Sultan of Zanzibar. (Middle east- Arab Empire in Zanzibar because of so much good raw materials).

*In the **1860's +70's** saw a gradual increase in British trade and even some settlement in land.

⇒ **Man on the spot-** William Mackinnon (an ex army officer who wanted to make money in The area)

-**1877** he proposed a scheme for Britain to administrate a huge area of E.A. in name of Sultan of Zanzibar. Basically, he runs E.A. on behalf of the Sultan in order to take over E.A.

-the government sent an advisor out (Badger) to "help" Mackinnon; reality = his job was to make sure the Mackinnon's scheme never happened! Therefore, Badger went to annoy everyone in E.A. including the Sultan, and undermine the scheme which fell apart.

1877-1884 nothing happened!!

1884- German Explorer Kan Peters (not working for German government just explorer) made treaties with local chiefs in Africa.

- One day after the Berlin Conference, the German government accepted German occupation over areas explored by Peters. Mackinnon freaked out at this as the areas were next to the areas that the British were interested in.

- The British government stayed calm, but pressed others to non-formally map out who had influence over what (avoided formal occupation, but did secure informal areas of interest with treaties).

Sultan > Zanzibar

Germany > Tanganyika

Britain > Kenya and Uganda

1888- Mackinnon along with Imperial British East African Company was going to administrate the area. Mackinnon was on the Board of Directors

Strategic value East African Coast

-naval base > refueling base on the way to India. However, inland was more like W.A. – protecting British influence against rival trading groups.

Unlike W.A. there was very little investment in E.A. (suggest strategic value) not much money to be made from E.A. as it had no resources, simply farmland and no goods for war

***By 1888-1889** the realization was that E.A. was a useless place to have but too late to pull out British influence from (Propaganda Disaster)

Colonization because British would have been embarrassed leaving. It would make the British Empire look like it was declining

-Uganda + Kenya were very religious areas (so issue of prestige – better to spread Anglican Church rather than leave it to French Catholics or German Lutherans (also protestants, but not English ones!))

1890

- Tidying up what was going on
- Germany officially recognized British influence in Zanzibar
- Zanzibar became British protectorate
- In return British gave Germany a bit of land in W.A. and Helgoland (North Sea) a tiny island next to North West of Germany
- French influence in Madagascar given by Britain, negotiated over land influence

UGANDA- East Africa

- A lot of rivalry was going on in Uganda between Muslims from Zanzibar and the English protestant and French Catholics
(Missionaries come to convert people)

The king of Uganda died in **1884** and his son took over. In **1886**, the Bishop of English Church was killed under the king's orders, the king was Muslim and therefore was worried about Anglicans influence. Later on 30 Catholics were murdered in Plot (foreign interference) by Muslims! Civil war with Ugandan Christians and Muslims lasted for 4-5 years!

In 1892—Mackinen's company turned to British government saying we need help... financially and militarily in-order to establish law and order in Africa because they couldn't cope with the civil war as it was just a trading company and weren't militarily equipped or else try to evacuate.

- Government feared another Gordon
- **Worried if they lost Uganda they would expose Sudan**
- **1890-didn't have Sudan yet but needed Uganda to re-get Sudan!**
- **1893**—Rosebury (foreign minister) was young upcoming liberal, Gladstone was old fashioned.
- Roseberry used this issue to gain popularity, by arguing for more intervention, taking strength against Gladstone's old fashioned Liberalism.
 - Gladstone—no intervention old school
 - Roseberry- new conquer trade strategic
 - Uganda taken over by Britain completely. Politics changed people to want an empire (Roseberry's influence)